Lecture # 2

Understanding People at work

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Understand Personalities at Work

After this lecture you should be able to do the following:

1. ***Define personality*** and describe how it affects work behaviors.
2. Understand the role of ***values(***principles or standards of behaviour; one's judgement of what is important in life.***)*** in determining work behaviors.
3. Explain the process of ***perception*** and how it affects work behaviors.
4. Understand how individual differences affect ethics.
5. Understand ***cultural influences*** on individual differences and perception.

Advice for Hiring Successful Employees:
The Case of ***Guy Kawasaki***

Guy Kawasaki (www.guykawasaki.com) who is a Silicon Valley (San Jose-California) venture capitalist and the author of nine books.



Most individuals have personalities that can easily get **in the way** of their **objective**.

Advice for Hiring Successful Employees:
The Case of ***Guy Kawasaki***

Good people hire people that are **better than themselves**

He also believes that mediocre employees **hire less-talented** employees in order to feel better about themselves.

He believes that the ***role of a leader*** is to produce more leaders, not to produce followers.

Advice for Hiring Successful Employees:
The Case of ***Guy Kawasaki***

- Some managers ***fear diversity*** and the possible complexities that it brings, and

- They make the ***mistake*** of hiring similar individuals without any sort of differences.

Advice for Hiring Successful Employees:
The Case of ***Guy Kawasaki***

- Kawasaki has learned that ***mathematics*** and ***finance*** are the **"easy"** part of any job.
- He observes that the true challenge comes in trying to effectively ***manage people***.
- Kawasaki regrets the choices he made in college, saying, "I should have taken ***organizational behavior*** and ***social psychology***" to be better prepared for the individual nuances of people.

The Role of Fit

The Role of Fit

- While personality traits and other individual differences are important, we need to keep in mind that behavior is ***jointly determined*** by the ***person*** and the ***situation***.

- ***Certain situations*** bring out the best in people, and someone who is a poor performer in one job may turn into a star employee in a different job.

The Role of Fit

- Imagine that you are interviewing an employee who is
  - Proactive, and creative,
  - Willing to take risks
  - Outgoing personality
- Would this person be a good job candidate?
- What behaviors would you expect this person to demonstrate?

Question above is misleading. While human beings bring their traits to work, every organization is different, and every job within the organization is also different

The Role of Fit

- Someone who is ***proactive*** and ***creative*** may be a great fit for a . .
  - Company in the ***high-tech sector*** that would benefit from risk-taking individuals
  - May be a ***poor fit*** for a company that rewards routine and predictable behavior, such as accountants.

- Similarly, this person may be a great fit
  - for a job such as a ***scientist***
  - but a poor fit for a ***routine office job***

The Role of Fit

Person-organization fit

- refers to the degree to which a person's
  - Values
  - Personality
  - Goals, and
- other characteristics match those of the ***organization***.
- Example: Very social, good communicator

Person-job fit

- is the degree to which a person's
  - Skill (technical)
  - Knowledge
  - Abilities, and
- other characteristics match the ***job demands***.
- Example: know the technology of electronics Engg.

The Role of Fit

- The first thing in fresh jobs many recruiters look at is the
  - ***person–job fit*** (technical skills).
- Companies are often also interested in hiring candidates who will fit into the ***company culture***.
- When people fit into their organization,
  - they tend to be ***more satisfied*** with their jobs
  - more **committed** to their companies
  - more influential in their company
  - they actually **remain longer** in their company

The Role of Fit

Example:

People who have worked in ***multiple companies*** tend to understand the impact of a company's culture better, and therefore they ***pay*** more ***attention*** to whether they will fit in with the company when making their decisions.

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Values and Personality

Values

- ***Values*** refer to . .
  - Stable life goals that people have,
  - Reflecting what is most important to them
    - Family, job or religion etc
- Values are established throughout one's life as a result of the accumulating ***life experiences*** and tend to be relatively stable.
- Example: somebody living is society where individual observe
  - Telling lie is very common (will he be honest ?)
  - Not following traffic rules is normal
  - Cheating in exam is NOT a crime
- Individual will have different value than somebody living society where
  - Telling lie is crime
  - Breaking traffic rules is major offense

Values

- The values that are important to people tend to affect
  - Types of decisions they make
  - How they perceive their environment
  - and their actual behaviors
- Moreover, people are more likely to accept job offers when the company possesses the values people care about.
- Heard about the Book "**Built to Last:** Successful Habits of Visionary Companies" written by Jim Collins ?

What are the values people care about?

Terminal Values

- refer to end states people ***desire in life***,
  - Such as leading a exciting life
  - Family Security
  - Self respect
  - Inner harmony
  - a world at peace

Instrumental Values

- deal with views on acceptable modes of ***conduct***,
  - such as being honest
  - Ethical,
  - Being ambitious
  - Broad minded
  - Forgiving

Where do values come from?

- Research indicates that they are shaped ***early*** in ***life*** and show stability over the course of a lifetime.
- ***Early family experiences*** are important influences over the dominant values.
- People who were raised in families with ***low socioeconomic*** status and those who experienced restrictive parenting often display ***conformity*** values when they are adults.
- While those who were raised by parents who were cold toward their children would likely value and desire security.

Personality

- ***Personality*** encompasses the relatively stable feelings, thoughts, and ***behavioral patterns*** a person has.
- Our personality differentiates us from other people, and understanding someone's personality gives us clues about how that person is likely to act and feel in a variety of situations.
- In order to ***effectively manage*** organizational behavior, an understanding of different employees' personalities is helpful.
- Having this knowledge is also useful for placing people in jobs and organizations.

Personality

- If personality is stable, does this mean that it does not change?

- You probably remember how you have changed and evolved as a result of your own life experiences,
  - Attention you received in early childhood
  - The style of parenting you were exposed to
  - Successes and failures you had in high school
  - and other life events.

- In fact, our personality changes over long periods of time.

Personality

- Two most popular ways to study personality
  - Big Five Personality traits
  - Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)

Big Five Personality Traits

Trait	Description
Openness	Person is being curious, original, intellectual, creative, and open to new ideas.
Conscientiousness	Person is being organized, systematic, punctual, achievement oriented, and dependable.
Extraversion	Person is being outgoing, talkative, and sociable, and enjoys being in social situations.
Agreeableness	Person is being nice, tolerant, sensitive, trusting, kind, and warm.
Neuroticism (or emotionality)	Person is being anxious, irritable, aggressive, temperamental, and moody.

Openness

- **Openness** is the degree to which a person is curious, original, intellectual, creative, and open to new ideas.

- People high in openness seem to thrive in situations that require being flexible and learning new things.
  - They are highly motivated to learn new skills
  - They do well in training settings

  - Open people are highly adaptable to change
  - Teams that experience unforeseen changes in their tasks do well if they are populated with people high in openness

Big Five Personality Traits

Conscientiousness

- **Conscientiousness** refers to the degree to which a person is organized, systematic, punctual, achievement oriented, and dependable.
- Conscientious people have higher levels of motivation to perform
  - Lower levels of turnover,
  - Lower levels of absenteeism
  - Higher levels of safety performance at work
- It seems that conscientiousness is a good trait to have for ***entrepreneurs.***
- Highly conscientious people are more likely to start their own business.

Big Five Personality Traits

Extraversion

- **Extraversion** is the degree to which a person is outgoing, talkative, and sociable, and enjoys being in social situations.
- One of the established findings is that they tend to be effective in jobs involving **sales**.
- They tend to be ***effective managers*** and they demonstrate inspirational ***leadership*** behaviors.
- Extraverts do well in social situations. Part of their success comes from how they prepare for the job interview.
- They actively seek information and feedback, and build effective relationships, which helps with their adjustment.

Big Five Personality Traits

Agreeableness

- **Agreeableness** is the degree to which a person is nice, tolerant, sensitive, trusting, kind, and warm. Agreeableness are likeable people who get along with others.
- Agreeable people help others at work consistently, and this helping behavior is not dependent on being in a good mood.
- This may reflect their ability to show **empathy** and give people the benefit of the doubt.
- Agreeable people may be a valuable addition to their teams and may be ***effective leaders*** because they create a ***fair environment*** when they are in leadership positions.
- Not agreeable are shown to quit their jobs unexpectedly, perhaps in response to a conflict they engage with a boss or a peer.

Big Five Personality Traits

Neuroticism

- **Neuroticism** refers to the degree to which a person is anxious, irritable, aggressive, temperamental, and moody.

- These people have a tendency to have ***emotional problems*** and ***experience stress*** and ***depression*** on a habitual basis.
- People very high in neuroticism experience a number of problems at work.
  - For example, they are **less likely** to be someone people go to for advice and friendship.

- They may experience ***relationship difficulties.***
- They tend to be habitually ***unhappy*** in their jobs and report high intentions to leave, but they do not necessarily actually leave their jobs.

- If they achieve managerial jobs, they tend to create an ***unfair climate*** at work.

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)

- Unlike the Big Five, which assesses traits, MBTI measures types. MBTI on the other hand, classifies people as one of **16 types**.
- MBTI was developed in 1943 by a mother–daughter team, ***Isabel Myers*** and ***Katherine Cook Briggs***.
- Its objective at the time was to aid World War II veterans in ***identifying*** the ***occupation*** that would suit their personalities.

Understand Personalities at Work

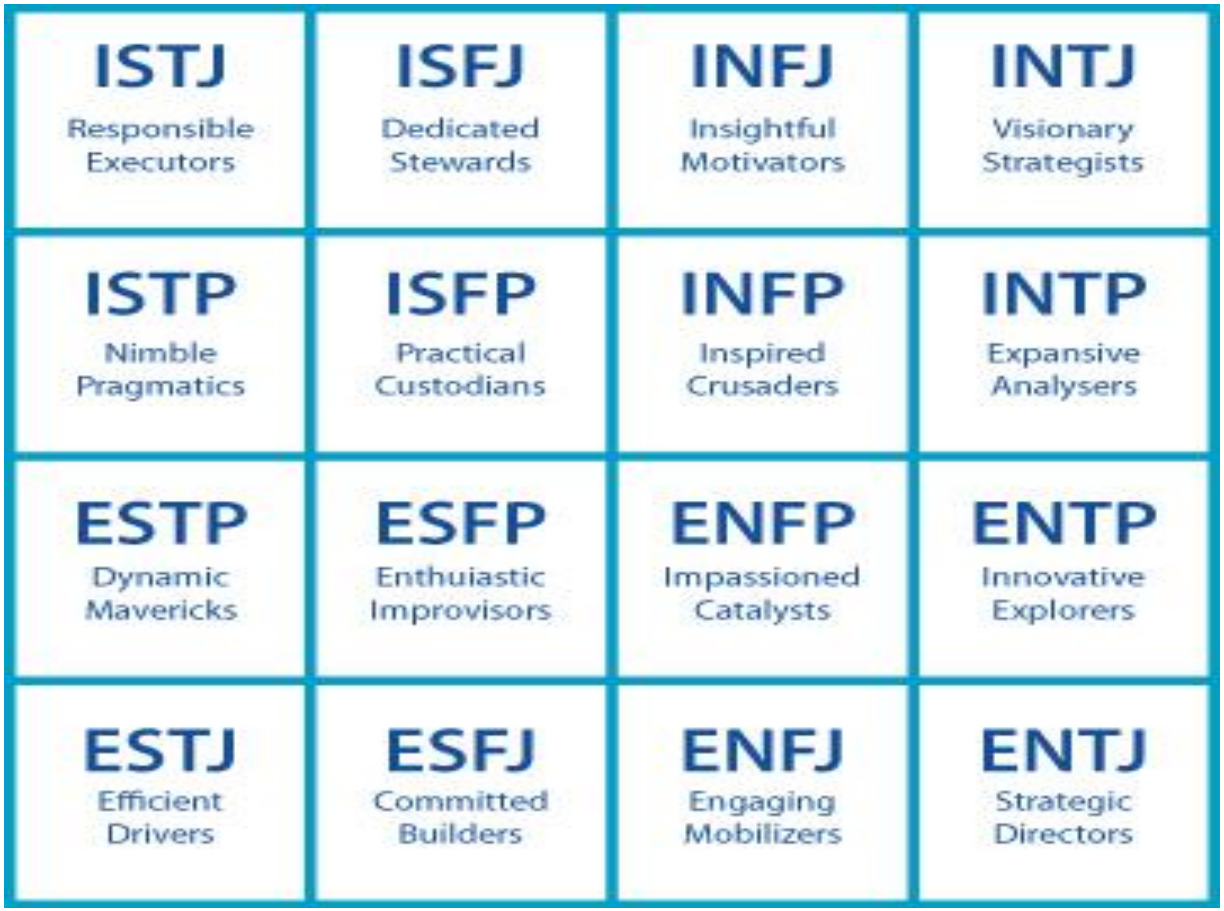
Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)

- ***Favorite world:*** Do you prefer to focus on the outer world or on your own inner world?
  - Extraversion **(E) :** Those who drive energy from other people and objects.
  - Introversion **(I):** Those who drive energy from inside
- ***Information:*** Do you prefer to focus on the basic information you take in or do you prefer to interpret and add meaning?
  - Sensing **(S):** Those who reply on their 5 sense.
  - Intuition **(N):** Those who reply on their intuitions & hunches
- ***Decisions:*** When making decisions, do you prefer to first look at logic and consistency or first look at the people and special circumstances?
  - Thinking **(T):** Those who use their logic.
  - Feeling **(F):** Those who use their values & ideas
- ***Structure:*** In dealing with the outside world, do you prefer to get things decided or do you prefer to stay open to new information and options?
  - Judging **(J)**
  - Perceiving **(P)**

EXTROVERSION	INTROVERSION
initiating	receiving
expressive	contained
gregarious	intimate
active	reflective
enthusiastic	reserved
SENSING	**INTUITION**
concrete	abstract
realistic	imaginative
practical	conceptual
experimental	theoretical
traditional	original
THINKING	**FEELING**
logical	empathetic
reasonable	compassionate
questioning	accommodating
critical	accepting
tough	tender
PERCEIVING	**JUDGING**
casual	systematic
open-ended	planning
pressure-prompted	early starting
spontaneous	scheduled
emergent	methodical

Understand Personalities at Work

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)



www.16personalities.com/free-personality-test

Understand Personalities at Work

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)

Careers Based Personality Type:

ISTJ Management Administration Law enforcement Accounting	**ISFJ** Education Health care Religious settings	**INFJ** Religion Counseling Teaching Arts	**INTJ** Scientific or technical fields Computers Law
ISTP Skilled trades Technical fields Agriculture Law Enforcement Military	**ISFP** Health care Business Law enforcement	**INFP** Counseling Writing Arts	**INTP** Scientific or technical fields
ESTP Marketing Skilled trades Business Law enforcement Applied technology	**ESFP** Health care Teaching Coaching Childcare worker Skilled trades	**ENFP** Counseling Teaching Religion Arts	**ENTP** Science Management Technology Arts
ESTJ Management Administration Law enforcement	**ESFJ** Education Health care Religion	**ENFJ** Religion Arts Teaching	**ENTJ** Management Leadership

That is all